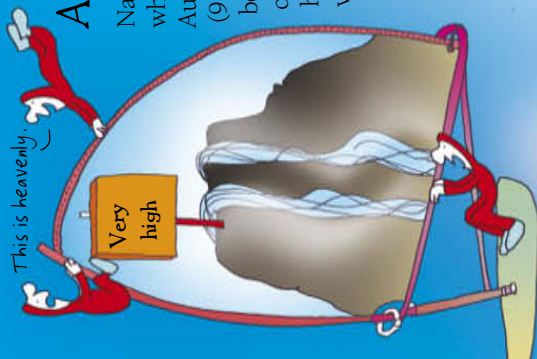


SOUTH AMERICA

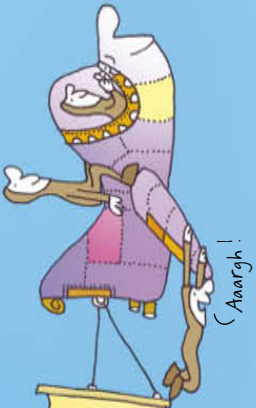
The triangle-shaped continent of South America is the fourth largest in size. The towering Andes mountains stretch the length of its Pacific coast from Colombia in the north to the tip of Chile and Argentina in the south. To the east of the Andes lie the massive and luscious Amazon rain forest, and the grassy Gran Chaco and Pampas regions.



Angel Falls

Named after American pilot Jimmy Angel who spotted the falls in 1935, water from the Auyantepui plateau in Venezuela falls 3,212ft (979m) into the Churún River below. Its greatest single drop of 2,648ft (807m) is the highest uninterrupted waterfall in the world.

Very high



Km 0 100 200 400 600 800
Miles 0 100 200 400 600 800

Amazon River

The Amazon River rises in the Andes and, after a lengthy journey of about 4,000 miles (6,400km), tips itself into the Atlantic Ocean. It carries more water than the Nile (the longest river in the world), has the largest drainage basin of any river anywhere, and is so wide that not a single bridge crosses over it.

It's off the charts!

Ain't no river wide enough...

Very Wide

Can I order some books here?

Georgetown, GUYANA

Paramaribo, SURINAME

Cayenne, FRENCH GUIANA

Caracas, VENEZUELA

Llanos

Orinoco

Guiana Highlands

Bogotá, COLOMBIA

Quito, ECUADOR

Equator

Lima, PERU

La Paz, BOLIVIA

Sucre, BOLIVIA

Brasília, BRAZIL

Brazilian Highlands

Amazon rain forest

Almost the entire Amazon River basin is covered in the largest tropical rain forest in the world. One-fifth of all the world's species of birds lives here, as well as 2.5 million insect species, 2,000 different mammals, and many thousands of different types of trees and plants.

—Is that a leak?

what leak?

Amazon

Amazon basin

Aaargh!

Grow!

A balmy palm!

There's something fishy about this.

Boo!

Lake Titicaca

The world's highest navigable lake, Lake Titicaca is 12,507ft (3,812m) above sea level. It lies on the border between Bolivia and Peru, and is home to the Uru people who live on artificial islands made from the reeds that grow there.

